

I RESPECT THE STANDARD

Club Name:

THE GRASSROOTS CODE FOR ADULTS IN YOUTH FOOTBALL

**ENJOY
THE GAME**

We're here to enjoy ourselves...win, lose or draw.

To help make football more enjoyable for all I should:

- Come to training and matches with a positive attitude and put the well-being of children first.
- Recognise examples of respect, effort and good play, as well as achievement.
- Appreciate grassroots football should be about children playing and having fun, not solely about results.

**GIVE
RESPECT**

We always treat others as we'd like to be treated. To give respect at football I must:

- Always use respectful and positive language and actions.
- Not argue with the referee, coach, and officials, and accept their decisions.
- Avoid coaching from the sidelines as a spectator, recognising this is likely to cause uncertainty and confusion across the team.
- Encourage children to show fair play by shaking hands with opponents and being kind, whether we win or lose.
- Stay in designated spectator or technical areas.
- Tidy up after myself and take care of the facilities we use.

**BE
INCLUSIVE**

We embrace our differences, football is a game for everyone.

To be inclusive at football I must:

- Show zero tolerance for discrimination of any kind.
- Report anything that concerns me via the relevant channel.
- Treat people based on their character, and nothing else.
- Accept that we all bring our own personal perspectives to the game.
- Not exclude anyone because of background or personal characteristics.
- Strive to give fair playing time to all children.

**WORK
TOGETHER**

We're a team, on and off the pitch. To help us bond as a team I should:

- Remember we are 'one team' helping young people enjoy football.
- Encourage players and celebrate their effort.
- Avoid criticising players if they make a mistake.
- Discourage cheating, complaining and time wasting from everyone.
- Accept that my child may not always be able to play in their favourite position, or may need to make a break to give someone else playing time.



**LOVE FOOTBALL.
PROTECT THE GAME.**





We all have a role in safeguarding young people and vulnerable adults.

To keep everyone safe I must:

- Accept it is my responsibility to know if my role in football places me in a position of trust.
- Speak to my Club or League Designated Safeguarding Officer if I am unsure whether I am in a position of trust.
- Understand appropriate boundaries must be in place, both online and during face-to-face activity.
- Let a Club Official know if I see anything that looks unsafe.
- Be aware of who the first aiders are, and where the nearest Automatic External Defibrillator is located.
- Keep appropriate boundaries by:
 - Always putting the well-being of children first.
 - Being friendly but professional.
 - Encouraging children to review their own progress.
 - Raising concerns about a child to the Club Welfare Officer if they display behaviour not usual to them or which causes concern.
- Follow the 'Physical contact and young people: Guidance for grassroots football' guidelines. If my role requires physical contact with a child, I will:
 - Ask the child's permission and explain the type of, and reason for the physical contact.
 - Keep physical contact to skill development, first aid, harm prevention or celebration of success or comfort in times of distress.
 - Ensure another responsible adult is present for the duration.
 - Remember physical touch should be culturally sensitive to a child.
 - Not participate in training, warm up or cool down sessions with children (including my own) to protect them from accidental physical harm.

**If I DON'T
live up
to the
Standard**

I understand that my club, League, County FA or The FA may take action, that could include:

- Giving me a verbal warning.
- Asking me to meet with the Club, League or CFA Designated Safeguarding Officer.
- Asking me to meet with the Club Committee.
- Asking that I complete an FA education course.
- Asking that I leave the match venue.
- Requesting that I do not attend future games.
- Suspending me or removing my Club membership.
- Fining me.
- Fining and/or suspending my Club.

About Referees, Assistant Referees and Match Officials:

The FA believes that all Match Officials should be able to officiate free from the threat of violence or intimidation. Any threatening behaviour or physical contact on a Match Official will result in a lengthy exclusion from football and possibly a criminal prosecution.

SIGNED:

Shomes

DATE:



**LOVE FOOTBALL.
PROTECT THE GAME.**

